

SONG JOURNEY

"All Along the Watchtower"

Bob Dylan · made famous by Jimi Hendrix

Thread song — it appears across all 5 modules

One song, five layers. Each module adds a new skill to this song. Layer 6 is a bonus — a three-part Hendrix-style lead.

Form	One loop, repeating under every verse and every solo
The loop	Am · G · F · G
Who plays it	Dylan sings over it; Hendrix solos over it
Rhythm	Teaching layers: 2 beats per chord.
Tempo	Practice at 60 BPM. Play-along track: 115 BPM.

LAYER 1 Listen

Module 1

This song exists twice: Dylan's original and Hendrix's cover. Same three chords, very different guitars.

1. Listen for which guitar is acoustic and which is electric.
2. Listen for how each version feels.
3. Listen for the Am · G · F · G loop repeating underneath.

Do it: Listen to the opening minute of both versions.
Decide which guitar is acoustic and which is electric.
Name one word for how each version feels.

You've got it when: You can hum the main hook from memory.

Level up

Listen once more. Find where the main solo changes from melody, to slide, to wah pedal.

LAYER 2 Bass Line

Module 2

Three notes on the low E string carry this whole song: the roots of the Am · G · F · G loop. This riff was your Module 2 assessment piece.

Bass loop · low E string · one lap = two bars

	A	A	G	G	F	F	G	G	(loop)	
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----		
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----		
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----		
D	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----		
A	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----		
E	--5-----5-----3-----3--	--1-----1-----3-----3--								

Play it: Pick one note per beat at 60 BPM. Each root twice before it changes.
Run 4 laps without stopping.

Index on fret 1 (F). Ring on fret 3 (G). Pinky on fret 5 (A).

You've got it when: You can play it from memory at 60 BPM, no stops.

Level up

Pick each root twice per beat instead of once. Same frets, same order.

Level up · 2 notes per beat · one lap = 2 bars

	A	G	F	G	(loop)
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	
D	-----	-----	-----	-----	
A	-----	-----	-----	-----	
E	5-5-5-5-3-3-3-3--	1-1-1-1-3-3-3-3--			

LAYER 3 Power Chords**Module 3**

Same three roots you played in Layer 2 — each note now also plays the note a fifth above it. G5 and F5 keep their root on the low E string; A5 moves to the open A string, so the loop crosses both root strings every lap.

Power chords · roots on low E and A · one lap = two bars

	A5	A5	G5	G5	F5	F5	G5	G5	(loop)
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	
D	--2-----	--2-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	
A	--0-----	--0-----	--5-----	--5-----	--3-----	--3-----	--5-----	--5-----	
E	-----	-----	--3-----	--3-----	--1-----	--1-----	--3-----	--3-----	

Play it: Strum once per beat at 60 BPM. Each chord twice before it changes.

Run 4 clean laps. Land every change on the beat.

A5 is one finger on the D string with open A ringing under it. Land the whole hand at once on each change.

You've got it when: The loop runs at 60 BPM, every string ringing clean, no stops.

Level up

Change chords every beat instead of every 2 — same 60 BPM, twice the changes.

Level up · power chords, one per beat · 60 BPM

	A5	G5	F5	G5		A5	G5	F5	G5	
	1	2	3	4		1	2	3	4	

LAYER 4 Pentatonic Solo**Module 4**

The loop is in A minor, so A minor pentatonic Pattern 1 fits every bar — this is the fret shape Hendrix used for most of his solos. Start with three notes and leave gaps of silence between them.

Three rungs. Climb them in order.

Rung 1 · Rule of 3 — start here**Three starting notes · A minor pentatonic Pattern 1 · 5th position**

	E	G	A
e	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----
D	-----5-----7-----		
A	--7-----		
E	-----		

Play it: Loop the chords (play along, or with a partner on Layer 3).

Improvise 4 bars on the 3 notes, then 4 more adding 1 note from Pattern 1.

Start or end every phrase on A — the home note.

Rung 2 · The whole box

The whole box · A minor pentatonic Pattern 1 · 5th position

```

e | --5-----8----- |
B | --5-----8----- |
G | --5-----7----- |
D | --5-----7----- |
A | --5-----7----- |
E | --5-----8----- |

```

Play it: Play the box up and down, softly. Then improvise anywhere inside it.

Rung 3 · Two Hendrix-style licks

Lick 1 · down and back up · quarter notes, lands on A

```

      C      A      G      A
e | --8----5-----5-- |
B | -----8----- |
G | ----- |
D | ----- |
A | ----- |
E | ----- |

```

Lick 2 · the slide-in · lands on A

```

      G/A      C      A
e | ----- |
B | ----- |
G | -----5--- |
D | --5/7-----7-- |
A | ----- |
E | ----- |

```

Play it: Practice each lick slowly. Then add it to a 3-note phrase.

You've got it when: You've climbed all 3 rungs — licks show up in your solos.

Level up

Bars 1–2: start on the F bar. Bars 3–4: land on A.

Level up · tension and release · 4 bars

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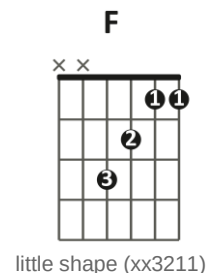
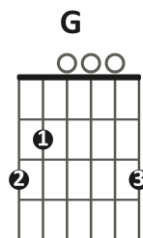
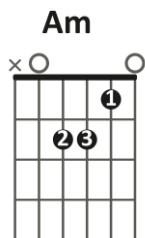
      C      G      C      G      C      E      A      C      D      C      A      A
e | ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |
B | ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |
G | --5-----5----- | --5-----7-----5----- | ----- |
D | -----5----- | -----7----- | -----7----- |
A | ----- | -----7----- | -----7----- |
E | ----- | ----- | ----- |

```

LAYER 5 Open Chords

Module 5

The simple singalong version — closest to how Dylan actually plays it. The same loop becomes full open chords you strum and sing over.



Singalong loop · 2 beats per chord · 60 BPM

	Am		G			F		G			(loop)
	1	2	3	4		1	2	3	4		

Play it: Down-strum, 2 beats per chord, 4 loops.**You've got it when:** The full loop runs at 60 BPM with every change on the beat.**Level up**

Trade loops with a partner playing Layer 3 power chords — Dylan and Hendrix at the same time.

LAYER 6 Hendrix Lead**Bonus***Optional harder challenge, no score. Best once Layer 4's pentatonic box feels automatic.*

Hendrix never just strums this song — his guitar answers the vocal with short fills (a fill is a short extra run between main parts). Three parts below, all from the Pattern 1 box you learned in Layer 4.

Rung 1 · Part A — the verse answer**Part A · the verse answer · one note per beat · 60 BPM**

	Am		G		F		G
	A	C	A	G	C	G	A

e		-----		-----		-----	
B		-----		-----		-----	
G		-----5-----		-----5-----		-----	
D		-----7-----7-----5-----		-----5-----7-----		-----	
A		-----		-----		-----	
E		-----		-----		-----	

Play it: Play one note per beat at 60 BPM, hand in 5th position — index fret 5, ring fret 7.

Play bar 1: A, C, A, G. Play bar 2: C, G, then land on A — let it ring 2 beats.

Rung 2 · Part B — the entrance**Part B · the entrance · slide into A**

	Am		G		F		G
	G/A		C	D	C	A	

e		-----		-----		-----	
B		-----		-----		-----	
G		-----5-----7-----		-----5-----		-----	
D		-----5/7-----		-----7-----		-----	
A		-----		-----		-----	
E		-----		-----		-----	

Play it: Slide up the D string, fret 5 into fret 7 — pick once, glide, land on A.

Let it ring 2 beats, then answer: C, D, C, home to A.

Rung 3 · Part C — the climb and the fall**Part C · the climb and the fall · quarter notes**

	Am		G		F		G
	A	C	D	E	C	A	G

e		-----		-----8-----5-----		-----5-----	
B		-----		-----5-----		-----8-----	
G		-----5-----7-----		-----		-----	
D		-----7-----		-----		-----	
A		-----		-----		-----	
E		-----		-----		-----	

Play it: Play bar 1: A, C, D, E.

Play bar 2: high C, A, G, then land on A.

You've got it when: All 3 parts run at 60 BPM and each one lands on A.

Level up

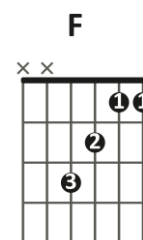
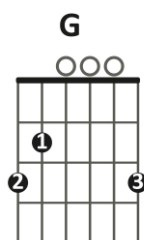
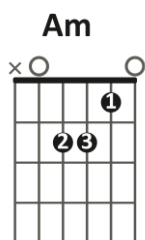
Play it the way Hendrix does: strum a lap, add Part A, strum again, open the next lap with Part B, and save Part C for the ending.

FULL CHORD CHART

"All Along the Watchtower"

Bob Dylan · made famous by Jimi Hendrix

Key A minor
Tempo 115 BPM (Neil Young play-along)
Rhythm Two beats per chord — one lap = two bars
Form Intro → Verse 1 → First solo → Verse 2 → Main solo → Verse 3 + outro — all over the same loop

Shapes you need**THE LOOP**

| Am G | F G |

The whole song is this one loop. Down-strums. 2 beats per chord.

INTRO

(loop, repeat)

Full band, full volume.

VERSE 1

(loop, repeat)

Vocal over the loop; lead guitar answers between lines.

FIRST SOLO

(loop, repeat)

Short solo from the pentatonic box (Layer 4).

VERSE 2

(loop, repeat)

Louder, fuller strumming.

MAIN SOLO

(loop, repeat)

Melody, then slide, then wah.

VERSE 3 + OUTRO

(loop, repeat)

The title line arrives here; the final solo fades out.

Teaching chart — simplified to match the Journey layers, not a note-for-note transcription. Chord names are what the class plays in standard tuning.

All Along The Watchtower Chords by Jimi Hendrix

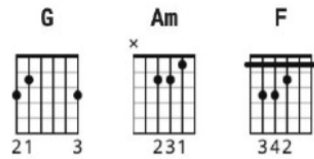


Difficulty: beginner

Tuning: E A D G B E

Capo: 3rd fret

CHORDS



[Intro]

G
Am G F G x4

[Verse 1]

Am G F G
There must be some kind of way out of here,
Am G F G
Said the joker to the thief.
Am G F G
There's too much confusion;
Am G F G
I can't get no relief.
Am G F G
Business men they, they drink my wine,
Am G F G
Plowmen dig my earth.
Am G F G
None of them along the line.
Am G F G
Know what any of it is worth.

[Solo 1]

Am G F G x4

[Verse 2]

Am G F G
No reason to get excited,
Am G F G
The thief, he kindly spoke.
Am G F G
There are many here among us
Am G F G
Who feel that life is but a joke,
Am G F G
But you and I, we've been through that

Am G F G
And this is not our fate,
Am G F G
So let us stop talking falsely now -
Am G F G
The hour is getting late.

[Solo 2]

Am G F G x16

[Verse 3]

Am G F G
All along the watchtower
Am G F G
Princes kept the view
Am G F G
While all the women came and went,
Am G F G
barefoot servants too.
Am G F G
Outside in the cold distance
Am G F G
a wildcat did growl.
Am G F G
Two riders were approaching
Am G F G
and the wind began to howl.

[Outro] (with ad-lib vocals)

Am G F G x9
(fade out)